

■ By Kimi Dangor

The cameras were waiting for a wardrobe malfunction and it almost happened. While model Candice Pinto covered her vanity with hands crossed in front of her tight hot pants, designer Nikasha Tawadey was more than a little embarrassed in the wings. The incident of the zipper-meets-expanding-waist-line went largely unnoticed, and Tawadey's eclectic collection Wandering Minstrels managed to snag the big buyers, selling out on the third day itself.

Just like Tawadey's little slip, Lakme Fashion Week (LFW) Spring Summer 2008 could have almost slipped by unnoticed, suffering from a fashion fatigue with this being the fourth fashion fiesta this year. So trends tallied, designers made all the right noises with cotton comfort, candy tones, eco-sensitive statements and prêt predilections even as Bollywood presented its B-grade show-stoppers. But one thing was sorely missing—the



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all-important buzz. And not even Bipasha Basu's sunshine turn for Narendra Kumar Ahmed, Kim Sharma's pouty sashay for Nalandda Bhandari and John Abraham and Rani Mukherji's front row presence could effectively pull this event out of its soporific stupor, till Manish Malhotra pulled out the stops and stars at the grand finale.

But to begin at the beginning, even the celebrity clamouring media machines had hit snooze mode, occasionally fetching up for a cutesy quote from Karan Johar (fast becoming a fixation at fashion shows) or a special appearance by Sourav Ganguly, and

SLOW MODE

Trends tallied and new talent emerged at Lakme Fashion Week Spring Summer 2008, but fashion fatigue marred the prêt proceedings



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